

Learning Diary - Mobile Course

Name: Jere Verkkomäki

Student Number: 001833690

26.7.2026

I Created the GitHub Repo and set up Android Studio. I created my first project (Exercise1), following the tutorial was slightly difficult as it was a decade old and everything had changed at least a little. Navigating Android Studio and setting up the simple calculator app, XMLs and Java code was straight forward. I learnt a lot about the software and how the views and the java code interact together such as EditTexts, buttons, views, onclick(), scaling and positioning objects. I had used Android Studio before about 1.5 years ago, and just recently did a web programming course that had many similarities to this. So using the software and Java was surprisingly easy.

Also time went by with getting the code to GitHub neatly and setting up a [README.md](#) file for the rest of the course. There were issues in pushing the code via the Android Studio terminal that I resolved with the help of AI after a while, and still I first ended up pushing the code to a wrong folder which I then manually fixed.

27.7.2026

Now that everything was set up, it was a lot easier to continue. I began by watching the second tutorial video and following it. The Android Studio UI was a lot easier to use and I tried using a mobile device via USB debugging instead of an emulator, and it worked on the first try. Simply entered the developer mode on the mobile device and plugged it into my laptop. I was away from home and had to use my laptop that has an Arm-based processor and it simply cannot use the emulator. Also Android Studio was extremely slow and buggy to use since it's not really compatible with my laptop.

Intents and transferring data between activities/views became clear as I followed the video. Also learnt about toasts and how to make a button that goes to a web page like Google. Intent extra keys were completely new to me as well. That it's technically a key-value pair that has to be unique and that way you can transfer data between views.

I revised my README and getting the code into GitHub went smoother than before, but not without any issues.

28.7.2026

I started by creating a new project (Exercise3) that would cover part 3 of the tutorial series. I learnt about listviews and recyclerviews and how they operate. Also importing image files and scaling them to the screen.

The tutorial I followed was by far the most difficult and longest one so far. I understood most parts, but since many parts were outdated, I did run into multiple difficulties that I eventually solved using the internet. I didn't use ListView but RecyclerView instead which had its own components and didn't use `setItemOnClickListener` like in the tutorial video for example. Also using the adapter as a sort of a bridge between the RecyclerView and the fruit data.

I had been wondering what warnings like: "Hardcoded string "My String", should use `@string` resource." even means and why. Following the video I finally learnt that it's good practice to transfer them to the strings.xml file instead and that gets rid of the many annoying warnings.

I finished the tutorial and next pushed the Exercise3 code into Github and began planning the project itself.

I decided to go with a simple workout tracker app, that lets one add workouts to a RecyclerView list, mark them as completed and add notes. I took some inspiration from my Android Studio project during my Object-Oriented programming course from last year but changed the concept completely. I used parts of the previous code in my new project and it was rewarding seeing everything slowly come together.

I created multiple activities and XMLs like a workout list, details list, workout manager that holds the data and bridged the data to a RecyclerView using another adapter just like in the tutorials.

Also it was finally time to make a slightly better UI than before, with little colors etc. And honestly most of my issues with the project were with the XMLs, placing objects on the screen and all that. Partly due to the extreme lag on my Arm-based laptop and partly due to my own incompetence. I'm happy with the end result though.

Overall the project went well and I like the app. There are multiple features I'd kind of want to add but didn't have time to as I started the course late. I worked a lot for 3 to 4 days but also learnt a huge amount. Couldn't have done this so quickly without any previous Java and Android Studio/Web dev experience.

Diary over.